of planting, cultivation and manuring and collecting statistics from the owners of estates, dealers and manufacturers, etc.

Tea Board

The Tea Board was constituted as a statutory body on April 1, 1954 under Section (4) of the Tea Act, 1953. The Tea Board which forms an apex body for the tea industry in India, is headed by a Chairman with its head office at Kolkata. It has sixteen Regional and Sub-Regional Offices spread over different parts of India. Besides, the Board has three foreign offices. The primary functions of the Tea Board include rendering financial and technical assistance for cultivation, manufacture, and marketing of tea; promoting tea exports; aiding research and developmental activities for augmentation of tea production and improvement of tea quality; encouraging and assisting the unorganised small growers' sector financially and technically; collecting and maintaining statistical data and its publication for the benefit of growers, processors and exporters.

Tobacco Board

The Tobacco Board was set up as a statutory body on January 1, 1976 under the Tobacco Act, 1975. The Board with headquarters at Guntur in Andhra Pradesh, is headed by a Chairman and is responsible for the development of the tobacco industry. The Board also has a Directorate of Auctions at Bangalore. The primary functions of the Board include regulating the production and curing of Virginia Tobacco; keeping a constant watch on the Virginia Tobacco market in India and abroad; ensuring fair and remunerative prices to growers; maintaining and improving existing markets and developing new markets abroad by devising appropriate marketing strategies. The Board is entrusted with the tasks of recommending to the Central Government the minimum prices that may be fixed; regulating tobacco marketing in India and abroad with due regard to the interest of growers, manufacturers and dealers; propagating information useful to growers, traders and manufacturers and purchasing Virginia tobacco from growers when the same is considered necessary for protecting the interests of growers.